

3.3 Unit 3, Option A: Revolution and Conflict in England

Focus

This option concentrates on how and why conflict and revolution threatened established regimes in England in the early modern period. Students study a range of factors associated with the emergence and outcome of these threats. They also address, and are invited to pass reasoned judgement upon, issues which have provoked disagreement and controversy among historians. A key element of study in this option relates to the evaluation of interpretations related to protest, crisis or rebellion.

Clarification of content for each topic can be found in *Appendix 1*.

Students entered for Option A are required to study ONE topic: A1 or A2.

A1 Protest, Crisis and Rebellion in England, 1536-88

- The development of the Tudor governmental machine, 1536-53: privy council, finance, local control and Parliament.
- Faction and court politics, 1539-53.
- Religious changes under Edward VI, Mary I and Elizabeth I, 1547-66.
- Anglo-Spanish relations, 1553-88.

Associated controversies

- a) How seriously did rebellion challenge the authority of the Tudor state in the years 1536-69?
- b) How significant were the developments that took place in the role and power of parliaments in the years 1566-88?